

The Brussels hearing · Defending your design

Organisation: Work in teams of three or four. On this sheet, the letters A, B, C and D stand for the team members; a team of three has no D (see first assignment). Settle who is who before the first assignment. Assignments 1 to 3 are team work, assignment 4 is individual.

Backup date: Exercise 6 is the lecturer's backup date. The bonus is made of the five regular exercises U1 to U5; this sheet only counts toward the bonus if Exercise 6 replaces a regular exercise that was cancelled. If so, this will be announced in Moodle.

Bonus points: In that case, the sheet counts toward the exam bonus if **every person** uploads their own transfer sentence (assignment 2), anchor sheet (assignment 3) and one change (assignment 4) no later than 48 hours after the session ends. Every submission carries a declaration line: if any AI tool touched it – tool, prompt, what you changed; if none: "No AI used." AI is excluded from the hearing and the defense panels themselves.

First assignment (25 minutes): A real regulatory hearing and your own colloquium both ask you to *defend* a design, and both run on the same structure: position, evidence, weakness, counter-argument.

Distribute the four camps of the pending case *EU Commission vs. TikTok* ("addictive design", preliminary findings of 6 February 2026; the case is not closed, and there is no model solution, for us either): (A) the Commission, (B) the TikTok defense, (C) a child-protection NGO, (D) the creative industry. In a group of three, the creative-industry camp is dropped. Based on your role reading, condense your position onto one index card: strongest argument · sorest point · one-sentence opening statement. One card, no additional notes. The role reading comes from the Topic 10 bridge, which is voluntary and goes on the Padlet; this sheet does not wait for it. If you come unread, the sources of every camp are in Moodle (Commission preliminary findings, EPRS briefing, BEUC material, TikTok statements): skim one of them in these 25 minutes, and let your camp cover the rest – that is what camps are for. AI stays excluded here too. If time remains, spend it reading one source of the *opposing* side crosswise.

Second assignment (50 minutes): The hearing. Forty minutes of negotiation: each camp delivers its opening statement (two minutes each, standing, no slides), then free negotiation chaired by the Commission, in which every camp must be attacked at its sorest point at least once. Two closing statements (Commission and defense, one minute each). Argue only from your card and your reading; whoever negotiates unread loses to their fellow students. The evidence rules of Topic 11 apply: only sourced claims count (source, year, institution), the chair strikes "studies show" without a named study, and a pending case stays pending.

Then ten minutes of deframing, out of role: which of the arguments you just made or heard applies to *your own* notification concept from Exercise Sheet 04? Each team member writes one transfer sentence, "*After this hearing, I change ____ in my notification concept.*", with the blank actually filled.

Third assignment (55 minutes): Now you defend your own project. Run defense panels in four rounds (three in a group of three), rotating the roles each round: one *defender*, one *moderator*, the others *critical audience*. The defender presents their core-argument slide and defends their project for five minutes. The critical audience then asks follow-up questions of the three types from Topic 12 (*Why not otherwise? What if X changes? How would you notice you were wrong?*) for another five minutes; they aim at the price, the limit and the evidence of the defense. Five plus five, the same times the panels in Topic 12 run on. The core-argument slide comes from the Topic 11 bridge, which is voluntary: if you have none, take one page from your own exposé – design question, chosen rung of the fidelity ladder, blind spot – and defend that. The defender handles the questions with the moderation moves from Topic 12: sort them, answer the stronger reading, park one and come back to it. The moderator keeps time and cuts monologues. The audience documents its feedback on one anchor sheet per defense, with the four looks from Topic 12 (trace visible, anatomy complete, moderation active, handling of the most uncomfortable objection), and hands it to the defender at the end of the round. Every team member defends exactly once.

Fourth assignment (30 minutes): The one change. Individually, compile:

1. **Your documented peer feedback:** the anchor sheet from your defense (or, if your round was cut short, the observation sheet of the strongest defense you watched).
2. **The one change** you make to your project or your argumentation in response. Exactly one.
3. **One sentence why this one** and not another.
4. **Declaration line.**

Your submission on Moodle is a single PDF per person, due 48 hours after the session: the transfer sentence (assignment 2), the anchor sheet (assignment 3) and the one change (assignment 4).